

WHO WE PREDICT WINS WHAT



MOST POINTS
BLICHFELD
Tappara

60
projected points



MOST GOALS
OJANTAKANEN
JYP

25
projected goals



BEST SAVE %
BARTOSAK
Pelicans

91.1
projected save %

TOP FIVE FORWARDS

1



BLICHFELD

Tappara

2



FORTIER

Jokerit

3



CURRY

Jokerit

4



KANTNER

Kärpät

5



WERNBLOM

TPS

TOP FIVE DEFENCEMEN

1



STENQVIST

Lukko

2



ÅKERSTRÖM

Sport

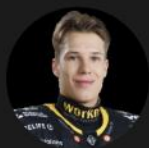
3



VATANEN

JYP

4



TICHACEK

Kärpät

5



CAITO

Jokerit

TOP FIVE GOALIES

1



JUEL

HIFK

2



BARTOSAK

Pelicans

3



RIMPINEN

K-Espoo

4



RUBIN

Kärpät

5



HELJANKO

Tappara

LIIGA 2026-27 · FIRST SEASON IN LIIGA

ALL-NEWCOMER STARTING SIX

G



JUEL

HIFK · from SHL

D



ÅKERSTRÖM

Sport · from Allsvenskan

D



NYCHUK

HPK · from ECHL

F



DIACO

Sport · from Allsvenskan

F



LINDQVIST

Tappara · from SHL

F



OLOFSSON

Jukurit · from Allsvenskan

None of these six has ever played a Liiga game

HOW IT IS BUILT

1 BUILT FROM PLAYERS, NOT LAST SEASON

Five seasons of goals per game for every player on every roster, with the most recent season weighted heaviest.

2 FOREIGN LEAGUES CONVERTED, NOT GUESSED

An import's scoring is rescaled into Liiga terms — **SHL 1.20, AHL 1.15, Allsvenskan 0.75, Mestis 0.35** — set from players who actually made that move.

3 AGE IS A CLIFF, NOT A SLOPE

Output holds up to about 28, then falls away fast: **0.67** of the previous rate at 35–37, **0.40** at 38 and over. Measured, not assumed.

4 GOALIES CARRY THE DEFENCE

Each team's projected save percentage becomes a goals-against multiplier, pulled toward the league average so one hot 20-game run does not distort it.

5 TWO MODELS, THEN 10,000 SEASONS

A goal-scoring model and a team-strength rating vote **40/60** on every game. The full schedule is then simulated **10,000** times.

THE MATCH MODEL

Goals come from a **Poisson** model, $\lambda = \text{lgAvg} \times \text{off} \times \text{def} \times \text{home_ice}$, with a **Dixon-Coles** correction on the low-score diagonal so the simulated OT rate matches Liiga's observed 23%. Blended **40/60** with a margin-of-victory **Elo** rating ($k=16$).

VALIDATION

Leakage-free backtest over 2023–26, each season rated on prior seasons only: points MAE **12.65**, game log-loss **0.672** vs a **0.686** base rate, standings **Spearman ρ 0.48**. Tuned on log-loss and MAE — ρ is too noisy at $n=4$ to optimise against.

Next: moving the pipeline to scheduled **Snowflake ML jobs** — refitting nightly on real results and re-simulating only unplayed fixtures.